Thai Red Chicken Meatballs Meal Prep

Serves 5 (meal-prep containers)

Ingredients

The Meatballs

- Ground Chicken – 1.5 lbs (700g)
- Zucchini – 6.7 oz (190g), grated
- Red Chili – 1, diced
- Ginger – 2 tbsp (20g), grated
- Garlic Cloves – 3, grated
- Cilantro – 1/2 cup (10g), chopped
- Green Onions – 3, sliced
- Egg – 1 large
- Soy Sauce – 2 1/2 tbsp (40ml)
- Lime – 1, zested (save it for juicing)
- Salt and Pepper – to taste

The Rice

- Jasmine or Long Grain White Rice – 1 1/2 cups (300g), rinsed
- Cold Water – 2 1/3 cups (550ml) for jasmine, or 3 cups (710ml) for long grain
- Salt – to taste

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Ingredients (Continued)

The Sauce

- Thai Red Curry Paste – 3 tbsp (45g)
- Green Onions – 3, sliced
- Ginger – 2 tbsp (20g), grated
- Garlic Cloves – 3, grated
- Coconut Milk – 1 can, 14 oz (400ml)
- Red Bell Pepper – 1 (190g), sliced
- Chicken Stock – 1 cup (250ml)
- Fish Sauce – 1 1/2 tbsp (22ml)
- Soy Sauce – 1 1/2 tbsp (22ml)
- Broccolini – 8.8 oz (250g), trimmed
- Lime Juice – from the zested lime
- Cilantro – to garnish
- Salt and Pepper – to taste

Notes

- **Storage:** Keeps for up to 4 days in the refrigerator, or up to 3 months in the freezer. Thaw overnight in the refrigerator, then reheat gently in a pan over medium-low heat, stirring well, or microwave for 2–3 minutes, stirring halfway, until steaming hot throughout.

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Instructions

1. **Make the Meatball Mix**
   Squeeze the excess moisture out of the grated zucchini with a paper towel; skipping this makes the mix too wet to hold its shape. Combine with the ground chicken, chili, ginger, garlic, cilantro, green onions, egg, soy sauce, lime zest, salt, and pepper. Mix gently and don't overwork it.

2. **Brown the Meatballs**
   Heat a large pan over medium heat with a little oil. Shape the mix into golf ball-sized meatballs and brown them in batches on all sides. They don't need to be cooked through yet. Set aside.

3. **Cook the Rice**
   Add the rinsed rice to a pot with the water and a pinch of salt and bring to a boil. Cover, reduce to low, and cook for 12 minutes (15–18 minutes for long grain). Take the pot off the heat and let it rest with the lid on for 4 minutes.

4. **Bloom the Curry Paste**
   In the same pan as the meatballs, add a little oil if needed, then the curry paste, green onions, ginger, and garlic. Fry until fragrant (1–2 minutes), scraping up the browned bits from the meatballs as you go. Frying the paste in oil before adding any liquid is what blooms the spices.

5. **Simmer the Sauce**
   Add the coconut milk, bell pepper, chicken stock, fish sauce, and soy sauce. Bring to a gentle simmer and let it reduce (5 minutes).

6. **Finish the Curry**
   Return the meatballs to the pan and simmer (6 minutes). Add the broccolini and simmer until it's just tender but still has bite, and the meatballs are cooked through to 165°F (4 minutes). Don't go longer; the broccolini turns mushy once it sits and reheats over the week.
   Season with salt and pepper, then finish with the lime juice and extra cilantro.

7. **Portion and Store**
   Divide the rice between 5 meal-prep containers (750ml each), then top with the meatballs, sauce, and broccolini. Let cool before sealing.

Source: Chef Jack Ovens – Thai Red Chicken Meatballs Meal Prep
https://chefjackovens.com/thai-red-chicken-meatballs-meal-prep/